



THE KENYA HIGH SCHOOL ALUMNAE SOCIETY

ADDENDUM

Career Briefs

A detailed profile of every profession in Your Career Guide — how to get there, what the work is really like, and where it can take you.

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DETAILED PROFESSION BRIEFS

Servire Est Regnare

TO SERVE IS TO REIGN

One Page Per Career, In Plain Language

This addendum goes deeper than the main Career Guide. It follows the exact same Zones and Rooms — use the main guide to find your room, then come here for the full picture on any specific profession. Institution names are illustrative examples, not a complete list — many other accredited Kenyan colleges and universities offer these same courses.

THE ROLE

What this profession actually involves, day to day, in plain language.

GETTING THERE

Typical KCSE subjects, the course/degree route, and example Kenyan institutions that offer it.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

A quick, honest snapshot of what a working day actually feels like.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

The strengths that make someone genuinely good at this, beyond the qualification.

WHERE IT LEADS

How this career typically progresses or branches over time.

GOOD TO KNOW

A fact worth knowing about this field in the Kenyan context.

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Health, Medicine & Human Performance

*"You care for people, ask "why" about the body, and want to
heal, treat, or protect health."*

Medical Practitioners

Room A1 Physicians

General physicians diagnose illness, order and interpret tests, and manage treatment for patients of all ages — often the first specialist a patient sees before being referred further.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Biology, Chemistry, and Physics/Maths.
Bachelor of Medicine & Surgery (MBChB), 6 years, e.g.
University of Nairobi, Moi University, Kenyatta University,
followed by a mandatory 1-year internship.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Ward rounds in the morning, outpatient clinics through the day, and decisions that shift by the hour as new results come in.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Diagnostic reasoning

Calm under pressure

Communication with patients

Stamina

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise later into any medical field (cardiology, paediatrics, oncology) via postgraduate residency.

Good to know: Kenya's public and private hospitals both hire MBChB graduates — but the internship year is compulsory before full licensing.

Room A1 Surgeons

Surgeons operate to repair injuries, remove disease, or reconstruct the body — from a 20-minute appendectomy to a 10-hour transplant.

GETTING THERE

Same MBChB route as physicians, then specialise via a Master of Medicine (MMed) in Surgery, 4 more years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Scrubbed in for hours at a time, then post-op ward checks — precision and steady hands matter as much as knowledge.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Fine motor control

Decision-making under pressure

Teamwork in theatre

Long-hour stamina

WHERE IT LEADS

Sub-specialise into cardiothoracic, neuro-, orthopaedic, or paediatric surgery.

Good to know: Kenyan surgeons increasingly perform procedures — like organ transplants — that once required travel abroad.

Room A1

Dentists

Dentists diagnose and treat problems with teeth, gums, and the mouth — from routine fillings to full reconstructive and cosmetic work.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Physics/Maths. Bachelor of Dental Surgery (BDS), 5 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Back-to-back patient appointments, each requiring precision work in a small space and a calm chairside manner.

SKILLS THAT MATTER**Manual precision****Patient reassurance****Attention to detail****Business sense (many run private practice)****WHERE IT LEADS**

Specialise into orthodontics, oral surgery, or paediatric dentistry, or open a private practice.

Good to know: *Most Kenyan dentists eventually run or co-own their own clinic — it's one of the more entrepreneurial medical fields.*

Room A1

Pharmacists

Pharmacists are the final safety check on every prescription — verifying doses, catching drug interactions, and advising patients on how to take medicine safely.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Physics/Maths. Bachelor of Pharmacy, 4-5 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Split between dispensing, counselling patients, and — in industry roles — quality control or drug regulation work.

SKILLS THAT MATTER**Attention to detail****Chemistry knowledge****Clear patient communication****Regulatory awareness****WHERE IT LEADS**

Move into hospital pharmacy, community pharmacy ownership, pharmaceutical manufacturing, or drug regulation (Pharmacy and Poisons Board).

Good to know: *Pharmacists are often the most accessible healthcare professional — many patients see one before they ever see a doctor.*

Room A1 Nurses

Nurses provide direct, hands-on patient care around the clock — administering medication, monitoring vital signs, and often noticing problems before anyone else does.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, and a mean grade meeting KMTTC/university entry. Diploma in Nursing (KMTTC, 3 years) or Bachelor of Science in Nursing (4 years), e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Twelve-hour shifts, dozens of patients, and constant triage of who needs attention right now.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Empathy under pressure

Sharp observation

Physical stamina

Clear documentation

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise into ICU, theatre, midwifery, or move into nurse education, hospital management, or public health.

Good to know: *Nursing is one of the most in-demand Kenyan qualifications abroad — but it's also the backbone of every local hospital.*

Room A1 Physiotherapists

Physiotherapists help patients regain movement and strength after injury, surgery, stroke, or chronic illness, through hands-on therapy and exercise programmes.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Physics/Maths. Bachelor of Science in Physiotherapy, 4 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

One-on-one sessions with patients, each needing a different, carefully progressed treatment plan.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Anatomy knowledge

Patience

Hands-on technique

Motivating patients

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in hospitals, sports teams, private clinics, or specialise in paediatric or neurological rehabilitation.

Good to know: *Every major Kenyan sports team now has a physiotherapist on staff — it's a fast-growing field alongside sports science.*

Veterinary Practitioners

Vets diagnose and treat illness and injury in animals — from family pets to livestock herds worth an entire farmer's income, to wildlife.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Physics/Maths. Bachelor of Veterinary Medicine (BVM), 5-6 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Egerton University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

No two days alike — a clinic morning could be followed by an afternoon farm visit or a wildlife conservancy call-out.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Animal handling

Diagnostic skill

Physical resilience

Client communication (with worried owners/farmers)

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise into livestock, wildlife/conservation medicine, small-animal practice, or public health (zoonotic disease control).

Good to know: Kenya's livestock economy and wildlife tourism industry both depend heavily on a strong veterinary workforce.

Public Health & Psychosocial Services

Room A2 Clinical Psychology

Clinical psychologists assess and treat mental health conditions — anxiety, depression, trauma — through structured therapy, not medication.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong grades, especially English/Biology. Bachelor's in Psychology (3-4 years) then a Master's in Clinical Psychology, e.g. University of Nairobi, Daystar University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

A day of one-on-one therapy sessions, each requiring full attention and careful, confidential notes.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Active listening

Emotional resilience

Analytical thinking

Confidentiality and ethics

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in hospitals, private practice, schools, or organisational/corporate psychology.

Good to know: Demand for mental health professionals in Kenya has grown sharply — it's one of the most under-supplied fields relative to need.

Room A2 Social Services

Social workers support vulnerable individuals and families — children, the elderly, survivors of abuse — to access the care, housing, or protection they need.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Social Work, 4 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University, Maseno University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Home visits, case meetings, and coordinating between families, courts, and NGOs on behalf of someone who needs an advocate.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Empathy

Case management

Conflict resolution

Resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into child protection services, NGO leadership, policy work, or counselling specialisation.

Good to know: Social workers are often the connecting thread between government services, NGOs, and the families who need them most.

Room A2

Primary Healthcare

Primary healthcare workers are the first point of contact in the health system — running community clinics, dispensaries, and basic diagnosis before referral.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry. Diploma in Clinical Medicine (KMTC, 3 years) or nursing/public health routes into primary care roles.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

A packed dispensary queue, treating common illnesses and deciding who needs to be referred to a bigger hospital.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Broad clinical knowledge

Triage judgement

Community trust-building

Efficiency under load

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into hospital administration, public health programme management, or further clinical specialisation.

Good to know: Primary healthcare workers see more patients per year, in total, than any hospital specialist in Kenya.

Room A2

Mental Health Counselling

Counsellors guide people through difficult life periods — grief, anxiety, relationship breakdowns — using structured conversation rather than clinical diagnosis.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, English. Bachelor's in Counselling Psychology, 3-4 years, e.g. Kenyatta University, Daystar University, Africa Nazarene University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

A rotation of individual and sometimes group sessions, each needing a fresh, non-judgemental start.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Deep listening

Patience

Boundary-setting

Cultural sensitivity

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise in school counselling, addiction counselling, family therapy, or trauma-focused work.

Good to know: Schools, churches, and workplaces across Kenya are increasingly hiring counsellors as mental health awareness grows.

Room A2

Epidemiology

Epidemiologists track how disease spreads through a population, using data to spot outbreaks early and design the response.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Biology, Maths. Bachelor's in Public Health or a science field, then a Master's in Epidemiology, e.g. University of Nairobi, Moi University, AMREF.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Analysing case data, mapping outbreak patterns, and briefing health officials on what the numbers mean.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Statistical analysis

Pattern recognition

Report writing

Public health knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the Ministry of Health, WHO, or global health NGOs on outbreak response and disease surveillance.

Good to know: Kenyan epidemiologists play a frontline role in tracking outbreaks like cholera and, before that, COVID-19.

Room A2

Community Health

Community health professionals design and run public health programmes at the grassroots — vaccination drives, nutrition education, sanitation campaigns.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, solid overall grade. Diploma or Bachelor's in Community Health, e.g. Kenya Medical Training College, Kenyatta University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Out in the community rather than behind a desk — running clinics, training community health volunteers, tracking programme results.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Community engagement

Programme planning

Cultural sensitivity

Data collection

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into NGO programme management, county health department leadership, or international public health roles.

Good to know: Kenya's Community Health Volunteer network is one of the most extensive in Africa — professionals in this field design and manage it.

Environmental Health

Environmental health officers protect public health from unsafe water, poor sanitation, and pollution — inspecting facilities and enforcing standards.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry. Diploma or Bachelor's in Environmental Health Sciences, e.g. JKUAT, Kenyatta University, Technical University of Kenya.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Site inspections of restaurants, water sources, or factories, followed by reports and enforcement recommendations.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Inspection rigor

Regulatory knowledge

Report writing

Diplomacy under pushback

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into county government leadership, water/sanitation NGOs, or environmental compliance roles in industry.

Good to know: *A single environmental health officer's inspection can prevent an entire neighbourhood's cholera outbreak.*

Sports Science & Physical Fitness

Room A3 PE & Sport Pedagogy

PE teachers and sport pedagogy specialists design how physical education is taught — building fitness, teamwork, and lifelong sport habits in learners.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, PE/Games background helps.
Bachelor of Education (PE option) or Bachelor's in Sport Science, e.g. Kenyatta University, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Leading active sessions across different age groups, then planning the next unit's skills progression.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Communication

Programme planning

Patience with beginners

Fitness knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into school leadership, coaching, or sport development roles at county or national federation level.

Good to know: PE teachers often become the first person to spot a future national-level athlete.

Room A3 Coaching

Coaches train individuals or teams — technically, tactically, and mentally — to perform at their competitive best.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream, sport-specific coaching badges/certifications from federations (athletics, football, rugby etc.) alongside a sport science degree.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Training sessions, video analysis, and matchday decisions that can define a season.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Tactical knowledge

Motivation

Observation

Composure under pressure

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress from school or club level to county, national team, or international coaching roles.

Good to know: Kenya's dominance in distance running is built on a deep, often informal, coaching culture in places like Iten and Eldoret.

Room A3

Sports Therapy

Sports therapists prevent and treat injuries specific to athletes — from pitch-side first response to long-term rehabilitation plans.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Physics. Bachelor's in Sports Science or Physiotherapy with a sports specialisation, e.g. Kenyatta University, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Pitch-side during matches, then clinic hours rehabilitating athletes back to full fitness.

SKILLS THAT MATTER**Injury assessment****Hands-on therapy****Quick decision-making****Athlete communication****WHERE IT LEADS**

Work with professional clubs, national teams, or open a sports injury clinic.

Good to know: *Every top Kenyan athletics camp now has sports therapists managing runners' injury loads.*

Room A3

Health & Fitness Science

Fitness scientists design evidence-based training and wellness programmes — for athletes, gyms, or corporate wellness schemes.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Maths. Bachelor's in Sports Science, Exercise Science, or Nutrition, e.g. Kenyatta University, Africa Nazarene University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing and testing training programmes, measuring fitness data, and adjusting plans based on results.

SKILLS THAT MATTER**Exercise physiology****Data analysis****Programme design****Client motivation****WHERE IT LEADS**

Move into elite sport science roles, gym/wellness business ownership, or corporate wellness consulting.

Good to know: *Kenya's growing gym and wellness industry has created real demand for scientifically trained (not just certified) fitness professionals.*

Room A3 Sports Management

Sports managers run the business side of sport — clubs, federations, leagues, and major events — from budgets to sponsorships to logistics.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Sports Management or Business with a sport focus, e.g. Kenyatta University, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Meetings with sponsors, event logistics planning, and managing the people and money behind the sport.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Organisation

Negotiation

Budgeting

Stakeholder management

WHERE IT LEADS

Run a sports club, federation, or move into major event management (e.g. marathons, continental tournaments).

Good to know: *Someone has to organise the Nairobi and Standard Chartered marathons — sports management is that career.*

Room A3 Sports Journalism

Sports journalists report, analyse, and broadcast the stories behind the game — on TV, radio, print, or digital platforms.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in Journalism or Mass Communication, e.g. University of Nairobi, Daystar University, USIU.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Matchday reporting, post-game interviews, and writing or broadcasting analysis on tight deadlines.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Writing under deadline

On-camera presence

Sport knowledge

Networking

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into major broadcast roles, sports podcasting, or international sports media.

Good to know: *Kenyan sports journalists cover some of the biggest storylines in world athletics, given the country's global running dominance.*

Sports Agents & Scouting

Agents and scouts discover talent early and negotiate athletes' contracts, sponsorships, and career moves.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business, Law, or Sports Management; agent licensing varies by sport/federation.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Watching matches and training sessions to spot talent, then negotiating deals on their behalf.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Talent evaluation

Negotiation

Relationship-building

Contract literacy

WHERE IT LEADS

Build an agency representing multiple athletes, or move into a federation's talent development structure.

Good to know: Kenyan athletics agents manage some of the highest-earning distance runners in the world.

B

STEM, Engineering, Earth & Life Sciences

“You love figuring out how things work — through logic, numbers, machines, or nature itself.”

Computing, Data & Cyber Sciences

Room B1 Computer Science

Computer scientists design and build the software, algorithms, and systems behind every app, website, and platform in use today.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Computer Science, 4 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT, Strathmore University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Writing, testing, and debugging code — often in a team, against a sprint deadline, solving problems that didn't exist yesterday.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Logical problem-solving

Programming languages

Debugging patience

Teamwork (Git/version control)

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into software engineering, product management, or found a tech startup.

Good to know: Nairobi's tech scene — the 'Silicon Savannah' — is one of Africa's largest, anchored by firms like Safaricom, Microsoft ADC, and hundreds of startups.

Room B1 IT & Informatics

IT professionals keep an organisation's technology — networks, hardware, software, data — running securely and reliably every single day.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Information Technology or Informatics, e.g. Strathmore University, JKUAT, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Troubleshooting systems, managing upgrades, and being the person everyone calls when something stops working.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Systems thinking

Troubleshooting

Customer service

Continuous learning

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into IT management, systems architecture, or specialise in cloud infrastructure.

Good to know: Almost every company, from a bank to a small NGO, now depends on at least one dedicated IT professional to function.

Room B1 IT Service Management

IT service managers make sure technology is delivered and supported at scale — the process and people layer behind a smooth IT department.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Maths. Bachelor's in IT or Business Information Systems, often with ITIL certification added post-graduation.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coordinating support tickets, managing vendor relationships, and ensuring service standards are met across an organisation.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Process design

Vendor management

Communication

Prioritisation

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into IT operations leadership or Chief Information Officer (CIO) track roles.

Good to know: Large Kenyan banks and telcos run entire departments dedicated purely to IT service management.

Room B1 Cyber Security

Cyber security experts defend networks, data, and people from digital attacks — from phishing scams to full-scale breaches.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Computer Science/IT with a cyber security specialisation, or certifications like CompTIA Security+, CEH.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Monitoring systems for threats, running penetration tests, and responding fast when something looks wrong.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Analytical thinking

Attention to detail

Ethical judgement

Continuous learning (threats evolve fast)

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise into penetration testing, digital forensics, or become a Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).

Good to know: As mobile money and digital banking have grown in Kenya, so has demand for cyber security talent to protect it.

Room B1 AI & Machine Learning

AI/ML specialists teach machines to recognise patterns and make predictions — powering everything from credit scoring to voice assistants.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Computer Science, Statistics, or Data Science, often with a Master's for research-heavy roles.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Building and training models, cleaning data, and testing whether the machine's predictions actually hold up.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Advanced mathematics

Programming (Python)

Statistical reasoning

Curiosity

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into research roles, AI product development, or found an AI-focused startup.

Good to know: Kenyan AI researchers are increasingly contributing to global machine learning research, not just applying it locally.

Room B1 Data Science

Data scientists turn raw, messy data into insight — the analysis behind everything from a company's next product to national policy decisions.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Statistics, Data Science, Computer Science, or Actuarial Science.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Cleaning datasets, running analysis, and translating numbers into a story decision-makers can actually use.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Statistics

Programming (Python/R)

Data visualisation

Business communication

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into senior analytics roles, data science leadership, or specialise in a domain like finance or health data.

Good to know: Kenyan banks, telcos, and agri-tech startups all run active data science teams on local data.

Room B1

Applied Mathematics

Applied mathematicians use advanced maths to model and solve real-world problems in engineering, finance, and computing.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Applied Mathematics or Mathematics, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Building mathematical models, running simulations, and validating whether the model matches reality.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Advanced problem-solving

Abstract thinking

Programming

Precision

WHERE IT LEADS

Feed into data science, actuarial science, engineering, or academic research.

Good to know: *Applied maths is the hidden discipline behind fields as different as insurance pricing and satellite navigation.*

Room B1

Statistics

Statisticians make sense of uncertainty — designing studies, analysing results, and ensuring conclusions (from research to national census) are actually valid.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Statistics, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT, Maseno University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing data collection methods, running analysis, and checking that results aren't just noise.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Rigorous analysis

Attention to method

Software (R/SPSS)

Clear reporting

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the Kenya National Bureau of Statistics, research institutions, or move into data science.

Good to know: *Every national statistic you hear — unemployment rate, inflation, census figures — passes through a statistician's hands.*

Industrial Design

Industrial designers shape the physical products people use every day — from furniture to appliances to packaging — balancing function and form.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Art/Design helps, plus Maths/Physics. Bachelor's in Industrial Design or Product Design, e.g. Technical University of Kenya, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Sketching concepts, building prototypes, and testing how a product actually feels in someone's hands.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Sketching/CAD software

Creative problem-solving

Understanding materials

User empathy

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in manufacturing, consumer product companies, or launch your own product design studio.

Good to know: *Every well-designed everyday object — a chair, a kettle, a phone case — started as an industrial designer's sketch.*

Engineering & Manufacturing

Room B2 Electrical Engineering

Electrical engineers design the systems that generate, distribute, and safely use power — from national grids to the wiring in a building.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths, Chemistry. Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering, 5 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing circuits or systems, running simulations, and supervising installation or testing on site.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Circuit design

Problem-solving

Precision

Safety awareness

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with Kenya Power, telecoms, manufacturing, or renewable energy companies.

Good to know: As Kenya expands its renewable energy grid, electrical engineers are central to connecting new geothermal and solar capacity.

Room B2 Mechatronics

Mechatronics engineers blend mechanical, electrical, and software engineering to build smart, automated machines — think robotics and automated manufacturing lines.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Bachelor's in Mechatronic Engineering, e.g. JKUAT, Dedan Kimathi University of Technology.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Working across disciplines — building a robotic system that needs mechanical design, electronics, and code all to work together.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Cross-disciplinary thinking

Programming

Mechanical design

Troubleshooting

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into robotics, automation, or advanced manufacturing engineering roles.

Good to know: Mechatronics is one of the fastest-growing engineering fields globally as factories automate.

Room B2 Mechanical Engineering

Mechanical engineers design and build machines, engines, and mechanical systems — from vehicle components to industrial equipment.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering, 5 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing components, running stress tests, and working with manufacturing teams to bring a design to life.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

CAD design

Physics application

Problem-solving

Project management

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in manufacturing, automotive, energy, or move into engineering project management.

Good to know: Mechanical engineering remains one of the broadest engineering degrees — it opens doors across nearly every industry.

Room B2 Biomedical Engineering

Biomedical engineers design the medical devices and technology that save lives — from prosthetics to imaging machines to hospital equipment.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Biology, Physics, Chemistry, Maths.
Bachelor's in Biomedical Engineering, e.g. JKUAT, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing or maintaining medical devices, working closely with clinicians to understand what patients actually need.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Engineering + biology knowledge

Precision

Regulatory awareness

Collaboration with medics

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in hospital biomedical engineering departments, medical device companies, or research.

Good to know: Kenya's hospitals increasingly need local biomedical engineers to maintain imported medical equipment, not just import it.

Manufacturing & Industrial Engineering

Manufacturing and industrial engineers design and optimise how products get made at scale — the systems behind every factory floor.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Industrial/ Manufacturing Engineering, e.g. JKUAT, Technical University of Kenya.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Analysing production lines, spotting inefficiencies, and redesigning processes to make them faster or cheaper without cutting quality.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Process analysis

Systems thinking

Quality control

Cost awareness

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into factory/plant management, supply chain, or manufacturing consultancy.

Good to know: *As Kenya pushes to grow local manufacturing under its industrialisation agenda, this field is set to grow fast.*

Earth Sciences, Energy & Mining

Room B3 Geoscience

Geoscientists study the Earth's structure to locate natural resources and understand hazards like earthquakes — reading what's beneath the surface.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Geography, Chemistry, Physics/Maths.
Bachelor's in Geology or Earth Science, e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Fieldwork collecting samples and data, followed by lab analysis and mapping what it all means.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Fieldwork resilience

Analytical thinking

Mapping/GIS software

Report writing

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in mining, energy exploration, environmental consulting, or disaster risk research.

Good to know: Kenya's Great Rift Valley makes it one of the most geologically studied regions on the continent.

Room B3 Energy (Power & Renewables)

Energy professionals generate and distribute power — increasingly from renewable sources like geothermal, wind, and solar — that runs the whole economy.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Chemistry, Maths. Bachelor's in Energy Engineering, Electrical Engineering, or Environmental Science.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Working on power generation projects, from feasibility studies to plant operations and grid integration.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical engineering knowledge

Project planning

Environmental awareness

Problem-solving

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with KenGen, Kenya Power, or international renewable energy developers.

Good to know: Kenya generates over 90% of its electricity from renewables — one of the highest shares in the world, led by geothermal.

Mining & Extractives

Mining professionals responsibly locate and extract the minerals modern life depends on — balancing economic value with environmental and community impact.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Chemistry, Physics/Maths, Geography.
Bachelor's in Mining Engineering or Geology, e.g. Taita Taveta University, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Site assessments, safety oversight, and coordinating extraction operations with environmental compliance in mind.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical/geological knowledge

Safety management

Environmental compliance

Community relations

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with mining companies, government regulators, or environmental consultancies.

Good to know: Kenya's mining sector — from titanium in Kwale to gold in Western Kenya — is a small but growing part of the economy, with real need for local expertise.

Environment & Conservation

Room B4 Climate Change

Climate professionals research and respond to shifting weather patterns, rising temperatures, and their impact on agriculture, water, and livelihoods.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Geography, Chemistry, Biology. Bachelor's in Environmental Science or Climate Science, e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Analysing climate data, running community adaptation projects, or advising policy on emissions and resilience.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Data analysis

Systems thinking

Policy literacy

Communication

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the Ministry of Environment, UNEP (headquartered in Nairobi), or international climate NGOs.

Good to know: Nairobi hosts UNEP's global headquarters, making Kenya a genuine hub for international climate careers.

Room B4 Wildlife Management

Wildlife managers protect and manage Kenya's iconic animal populations — balancing conservation, tourism, and human-wildlife conflict.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Biology, Geography. Bachelor's in Wildlife Management or Ecology, e.g. University of Nairobi, Karatina University, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Fieldwork monitoring animal populations, managing conservancy operations, or working directly on anti-poaching strategy.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Field research

Ecological knowledge

Community engagement

Resilience (remote conditions)

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the Kenya Wildlife Service, private conservancies, or international conservation NGOs.

Good to know: Kenya's conservancies alone protect more land than its national parks — private wildlife management is a major employer.

Room B4

Environmental Conservation

Conservationists work to preserve ecosystems and biodiversity — from forests to wetlands — for future generations.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Biology, Geography. Bachelor's in Environmental Science or Natural Resource Management.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Field surveys, restoration projects, and community education on sustainable resource use.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Ecological knowledge

Project management

Community engagement

Grant writing

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with NGOs like WWF or the Kenya Forest Service, or move into conservation policy.

Good to know: *Community-led conservancies in places like Laikipia are globally recognised models for balancing conservation and livelihoods.*

Room B4

Eco-Planning

Eco-planners design land use and development plans that protect the environment while still allowing growth — the bridge between urban planning and conservation.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Geography, Maths. Bachelor's in Urban and Regional Planning with an environmental focus.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Reviewing development proposals, mapping environmental impact, and negotiating between growth and protection.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Spatial analysis (GIS)

Environmental law knowledge

Negotiation

Systems thinking

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with county governments, the National Environment Management Authority (NEMA), or development consultancies.

Good to know: *As Kenyan cities grow fast, eco-planners are increasingly central to whether that growth is sustainable.*

Room B4 Waste Management

Waste management professionals design the systems that keep waste out of land, air, and water — from collection logistics to recycling infrastructure.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Chemistry, Geography. Bachelor's in Environmental Engineering or Environmental Science.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing collection/recycling systems, monitoring compliance, or running community waste reduction programmes.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Systems design

Regulatory knowledge

Community engagement

Logistics

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with county governments, waste management companies, or the growing recycling/circular economy sector.

Good to know: Kenya's 2017 plastic bag ban was one of the strictest in the world — waste management professionals helped make it work.

Room B4 Environmental Journalism

Environmental journalists tell the stories that hold polluters accountable and inspire public action — from climate reporting to investigative exposés.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in Journalism with an environmental/science reporting focus.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Investigating stories, interviewing scientists and affected communities, and writing or broadcasting to a wide audience.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Investigative research

Science literacy

Storytelling

Persistence

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with major Kenyan media houses, international outlets, or specialised environmental publications.

Good to know: Environmental journalism has driven real policy change in Kenya, including exposing illegal logging and pollution.

Agriculture, Food & Agribusiness

Room B5 Agronomy & Crop Science

Agronomists improve how crops are grown, bred, and protected — the science behind higher yields and food security.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Biology, Chemistry, Geography. Bachelor's in Agriculture or Agronomy, e.g. University of Nairobi, Egerton University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Field trials, soil and crop analysis, and advising farmers on what will actually grow better.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Plant science

Field research

Data analysis

Farmer communication

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with agribusiness companies, research institutes (KALRO), or international agricultural development organisations.

Good to know: Kenyan-bred drought-resistant crop varieties have helped farmers adapt to increasingly unpredictable rainfall.

Room B5 Animal Husbandry

Animal husbandry professionals raise and manage livestock for food, income, and export — from dairy herds to poultry operations.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry. Bachelor's or Diploma in Animal Science, e.g. Egerton University, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Managing herd health, breeding programmes, and feeding schedules to maximise both animal welfare and productivity.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Animal science knowledge

Business/farm management

Problem-solving

Physical resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Run a commercial farm, work with dairy/meat processing companies, or move into agricultural extension services.

Good to know: Kenya's dairy sector is one of the largest in Africa, built on both smallholder and commercial animal husbandry expertise.

Room B5 Fisheries & Aquaculture

Fisheries and aquaculture professionals farm and manage fish stocks sustainably — from Lake Victoria's wild fisheries to fish farming ponds.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Geography. Bachelor's in Fisheries and Aquatic Sciences, e.g. Kenyatta University, Egerton University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Monitoring water quality, fish health, and stock levels, or advising fish farmers on best practice.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Aquatic biology

Water quality management

Business planning

Sustainability awareness

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the Fisheries Department, aquaculture companies, or international fisheries management bodies.

Good to know: *Aquaculture (fish farming) is one of Kenya's fastest-growing agricultural sub-sectors, reducing pressure on wild fish stocks.*

Room B5 Agricultural Engineering

Agricultural engineers design the machinery, irrigation, and storage systems that modernise farming — from tractors to precision irrigation.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths, Chemistry. Bachelor's in Agricultural Engineering, e.g. JKUAT, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing or maintaining farm equipment and irrigation systems, and solving practical problems on-site with farmers.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Engineering design

Practical problem-solving

Understanding of farming systems

Maintenance skills

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with agri-equipment companies, irrigation projects, or agricultural development programmes.

Good to know: *Precision irrigation engineered for Kenya's semi-arid regions has turned previously unfarmable land productive.*

Room B5 Eco-Agriculture

Eco-agriculture specialists farm in ways that protect soil, water, and biodiversity — sustainable methods that keep land productive for the long term.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Biology, Chemistry, Geography. Bachelor's in Agriculture or Sustainable Agriculture.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing crop rotation and soil management plans, training farmers in sustainable techniques.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Sustainable farming knowledge

Soil science

Community training

Systems thinking

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with sustainable agriculture NGOs, organic certification bodies, or agri-consultancies.

Good to know: Organic and eco-certified Kenyan produce increasingly commands premium prices in export markets.

Room B5 Agribusiness & Value Addition

Agribusiness professionals turn raw produce into branded, exportable products — the link between the farm and the global market shelf.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Agribusiness Management or Agricultural Economics, e.g. Egerton University, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Working on processing, packaging, branding, or export logistics for agricultural products.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Business strategy

Market knowledge

Supply chain understanding

Negotiation

WHERE IT LEADS

Build an agribusiness company, work with export firms, or lead agricultural cooperatives.

Good to know: Kenyan value-added exports — like processed avocado oil or specialty coffee — earn far more than raw produce alone.

Aviation, Aerospace & Maritime

Room B6 Pilots

Pilots fly commercial, cargo, or private aircraft — responsible for the safety of everyone and everything on board.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics, English. Commercial Pilot Licence via an accredited flying school (e.g. East African School of Aviation, Kenya School of Flying), typically 18+ months.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Pre-flight checks, the flight itself, and constant communication with air traffic control throughout.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Precision

Calm decision-making

Spatial awareness

Continuous training

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress from co-pilot to captain, or specialise in cargo, charter, or long-haul international routes.

Good to know: Kenya Airways and Nairobi's Jomo Kenyatta International Airport make Kenya a major East African aviation hub.

Room B6 Flight Dispatch & Air Traffic Control

Dispatchers and air traffic controllers plan flight paths and keep every aircraft safely on course and on time, especially in busy airspace.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics, English. Specialised training via the Kenya Civil Aviation Authority or East African School of Aviation.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Monitoring multiple aircraft simultaneously, making split-second routing and safety decisions.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Intense focus

Multitasking

Clear communication

Stress management

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior control tower roles or airspace management leadership.

Good to know: Air traffic controllers are responsible for hundreds of lives in the air at any given moment — one of the highest-stakes jobs in aviation.

Room B6

Cabin Crew

Cabin crew ensure passenger safety and service in the air — trained first responders as much as hosts.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, English. Airline-run cabin crew training programmes (e.g. Kenya Airways), typically a few months.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Safety briefings, in-flight service, and handling anything from a medical issue to a difficult passenger, calmly.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Composure in emergencies

Customer service

Teamwork

Physical stamina

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior/purser roles, or move into airline training and safety management.

Good to know: Cabin crew are certified emergency responders first — service is only part of the job.

Room B6

Aerospace Engineering

Aerospace engineers design the aircraft and spacecraft of the future — from aerodynamics to propulsion systems.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths, Chemistry. Bachelor's in Aerospace or Aeronautical Engineering (often studied abroad; local foundations at JKUAT/UoN).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Modelling designs, running simulations, and testing how components perform under extreme conditions.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Advanced physics/maths

CAD/simulation software

Precision

Systems thinking

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with aircraft manufacturers, defence contractors, or Kenya's growing satellite/space programme.

Good to know: Kenya launched its first operational satellite in 2018 and continues building a small but real space engineering sector.

Room B6 Drone Operations

Drone operators fly and manage drones for mapping, agricultural monitoring, delivery, and infrastructure inspection.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, Physics/Maths helps. Kenya Civil Aviation Authority drone pilot certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Planning and flying missions, then processing the imagery or data the drone collects.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical piloting

Data/imagery analysis

Regulatory compliance

Attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in precision agriculture, surveying, film production, or medical delivery logistics (drones already deliver blood in parts of Africa).

Good to know: Drones are already used in Kenya for crop monitoring and, in some African countries, for emergency medical delivery.

Room B6 Airport Management

Airport managers run the operations behind a functioning airport — from runway scheduling to passenger services to security coordination.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Aviation Management or Business Administration.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coordinating between airlines, security, ground services, and passengers to keep operations running smoothly.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Operations management

Crisis handling

Multi-stakeholder coordination

Regulatory knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior airport authority leadership or regional aviation management roles.

Good to know: Jomo Kenyatta International Airport is one of Africa's busiest cargo and passenger hubs.

Room B6

Aircraft Maintenance Engineering

Maintenance engineers keep aircraft safe and airworthy — inspecting, repairing, and certifying every part before a plane flies again.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Aircraft Maintenance Engineering licence via Kenya Civil Aviation Authority-approved training institutions.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Detailed inspections and repairs, with every action logged and checked against strict safety standards.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical precision

Regulatory compliance

Problem diagnosis

Meticulous documentation

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior licensed engineer status, overseeing entire fleets' maintenance programmes.

Good to know: *No commercial aircraft flies without a certified maintenance engineer's sign-off — it's one of aviation's most safety-critical roles.*

Room B6

Maritime & Shipping

Maritime professionals manage vessels, ports, and global cargo trade by sea — keeping goods moving between countries and continents.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics, Geography. Bachelor's in Maritime Studies or Nautical Science, e.g. Bandari Maritime Academy (Mombasa), Technical University of Mombasa.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Port operations, cargo logistics coordination, or life at sea aboard a vessel, depending on the specific role.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Logistics coordination

Navigation/technical knowledge

Regulatory compliance

Resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to ship command, port authority leadership, or international shipping company management.

Good to know: *The Port of Mombasa is East Africa's largest port and a critical gateway for regional trade.*

C

Business, Finance, Trade & Leadership

"You think in strategy and numbers, and you're already asking how to make things grow."

Finance & Actuarial Sciences

Room C1 Financial Engineering

Financial engineers design complex financial products and investment strategies, using maths and modelling to manage risk and return.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Finance, Actuarial Science, or Financial Engineering, e.g. Strathmore University, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Building financial models, pricing products, and stress-testing strategies against market scenarios.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Advanced maths

Financial modelling

Programming (Excel/Python)

Risk analysis

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in investment banks, asset management firms, or fintech product design.

Good to know: Nairobi is East Africa's financial hub, home to the Nairobi Securities Exchange and a growing fintech sector.

Room C1 Financial Analysis

Financial analysts evaluate companies, markets, and investment opportunities to guide decisions on where money should go.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Finance, Economics, or Accounting; CFA certification often follows.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Building spreadsheet models, reading company reports, and writing recommendations for investors or management.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Financial modelling

Critical analysis

Report writing

Market awareness

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to portfolio management, investment banking, or corporate finance leadership.

Good to know: Financial analysts are behind every 'buy' or 'sell' recommendation you hear about a company's stock.

Room C1

Banking

Bankers manage how money moves — from personal savings accounts to the loans that fund entire businesses and national infrastructure.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, Maths helps. Bachelor's in Finance, Economics, or Business, e.g. University of Nairobi, Strathmore University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Client meetings, credit assessments, and managing the products and services a bank offers its customers.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Relationship management

Financial literacy

Risk assessment

Sales ability

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress from teller/relationship roles to branch management, credit, or corporate banking leadership.

Good to know: Kenya is a global leader in mobile banking, with M-PESA reshaping how the entire banking sector operates.

Room C1

Accountancy

Accountants track, audit, and report the financial health of any organisation — the discipline that keeps every business honest and solvent.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Commerce/Accounting, plus CPA-K professional certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Preparing financial statements, reconciling accounts, and advising on tax and compliance.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Precision

Regulatory knowledge

Analytical thinking

Ethics

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Chief Financial Officer (CFO), start an accounting firm, or specialise in forensic accounting.

Good to know: Every registered company in Kenya, no matter how small, legally needs accounting expertise to operate.

Room C1

Investments

Investment professionals grow wealth by allocating capital into markets, property, or businesses on behalf of clients or funds.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Finance or Economics, often with a CFA or investment-specific certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Researching opportunities, managing portfolios, and reporting performance to clients or fund stakeholders.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Market analysis

Risk management

Decision-making under uncertainty

Client communication

WHERE IT LEADS

Manage larger funds, move into private equity, or start an independent investment advisory.

Good to know: Kenya's pension and unit trust fund industry has grown rapidly, creating strong demand for investment professionals.

Room C1

Auditing

Auditors independently verify that financial records are accurate and honest — the check that protects investors, regulators, and the public.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Commerce/Accounting plus CPA-K certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Reviewing financial records, testing controls, and writing findings that can make or break confidence in a company.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Scepticism/scrutiny

Attention to detail

Ethics

Report writing

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior audit partner, move into forensic auditing, or become an internal audit director.

Good to know: Major corporate scandals worldwide have usually been caught, eventually, by a sharp-eyed auditor.

Room C1 Insurance

Insurance professionals price and manage risk, so individuals and businesses are financially protected when something goes wrong.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths. Bachelor's in Insurance, Actuarial Science, or Business, plus professional certifications (e.g. ACII, IIK).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Assessing risk, pricing policies, or processing claims — balancing customer needs against financial sustainability.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Risk assessment

Numerical skill

Customer service

Regulatory knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to underwriting leadership, claims management, or start an insurance brokerage.

Good to know: Insurance penetration in Kenya is still low compared to global averages — meaning huge room for the industry, and this career, to grow.

Room C1 Actuarial Science

Actuaries use statistics and maths to price risk — the reason insurance and pensions can promise to pay out decades into the future.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: very strong Maths. Bachelor's in Actuarial Science, e.g. University of Nairobi, Strathmore University, JKUAT, then professional actuarial exams.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Building models that predict long-term financial risk, and translating that maths into pricing and policy decisions.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Advanced mathematics

Statistical modelling

Long-term thinking

Precision

WHERE IT LEADS

Become a Fellow Actuary, lead an insurance company's actuarial department, or consult internationally.

Good to know: Actuarial science is consistently ranked among the world's best-paying, most secure careers — and Kenya trains some of Africa's top actuaries.

Entrepreneurship & Innovation

Room C2 Startup Founder

Founders build a business from a raw idea into a functioning company — raising money, building a product, and finding customers, often all at once.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream, business acumen matters more than a specific degree. Bachelor's in Business, Entrepreneurship, or any field paired with hands-on experience.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

No typical day — fundraising calls, product decisions, hiring, and firefighting whatever's most urgent that day.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Resilience

Resourcefulness

Sales/persuasion

Comfort with uncertainty

WHERE IT LEADS

Scale the company, raise larger funding rounds, or exit via acquisition and start again.

Good to know: Kenya's startup ecosystem has produced Africa-wide successes in fintech, agri-tech, and logistics.

Room C2 Incubators & Accelerators

Incubator and accelerator staff support and fund early-stage startups, providing mentorship, workspace, and capital to help them grow fast.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business, Finance, or Entrepreneurship, often with startup or investment experience.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Mentoring founders, reviewing pitches, and connecting startups with the resources they need to survive their first years.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Business evaluation

Mentorship

Network-building

Strategic advice

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into venture capital, corporate innovation, or launch your own incubator.

Good to know: Nairobi hosts some of Africa's most active startup incubators and accelerators, drawing founders region-wide.

Room C2 Seed Investing

Seed investors provide the first capital that gets new ideas off the ground, betting early on founders and concepts with high risk and high potential.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, strong Maths helps. Bachelor's in Finance, Business, or Economics, often with an MBA later.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Reviewing pitch decks, meeting founders, and deciding which very early, unproven ideas deserve a bet.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Judgement under uncertainty

Financial analysis

Network access

Negotiation

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to venture capital partner, or build your own investment fund.

Good to know: Kenyan startups have attracted more venture capital than almost any other African country in recent years.

Room C2 Innovation Management

Innovation managers lead how established organisations create and adopt new ideas — keeping big companies from getting left behind by smaller, faster ones.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business, Engineering, or Design, often with an MBA or innovation-specific training.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Running ideation workshops, testing new concepts, and building the internal case for change within a large organisation.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Change management

Creative facilitation

Strategic thinking

Persuasion

WHERE IT LEADS

Become a Chief Innovation Officer, or move into strategy consulting.

Good to know: Large Kenyan corporates increasingly run internal 'innovation labs' modelled on startup culture.

Leadership & Strategic/HR Management

Room C3 Institutional Strengthening

Institutional strengthening specialists build more effective organisations from the inside — improving systems, governance, and capacity.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business Administration, Public Administration, or Organisational Development.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Diagnosing organisational weaknesses and designing structural or process changes to fix them.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Systems thinking

Diplomacy

Change management

Analytical writing

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into development consulting, NGO leadership, or public sector reform roles.

Good to know: *Many international development programmes in Kenya are, at their core, institutional strengthening work.*

Room C3 Business Development

Business development professionals grow organisations by finding and securing new opportunities, partnerships, and clients.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business, Marketing, or a relevant industry field.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Building relationships, pitching partnerships, and negotiating deals that expand the organisation's reach.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Relationship-building

Negotiation

Strategic thinking

Persistence

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Business Development, or move into general management.

Good to know: *Business development is one of the most transferable skill sets — valuable in literally any industry.*

Room C3

Human Resources

HR professionals recruit, support, and develop an organisation's people — the function that makes every other department actually work.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Human Resource Management, e.g. University of Nairobi, Kenyatta University, plus IHRM certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Recruitment interviews, resolving workplace issues, and designing policies that shape how people experience work.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

People skills

Conflict resolution

Confidentiality

Organisational awareness

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to HR Director, or specialise in talent development or organisational culture.

Good to know: Every organisation, from a startup to a government ministry, needs HR expertise — it's one of the most universally in-demand careers.

Room C3

Talent Acquisition

Talent acquisition specialists find and attract the right people for the right roles, often the deciding factor in whether a team succeeds.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in HR, Business, or Psychology.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Sourcing candidates, running interviews, and selling great candidates on why they should join.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Networking

Judgement of character

Sales ability

Organisation

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Talent, or move into executive search/recruitment agency leadership.

Good to know: As Kenya's tech and finance sectors grow, specialist talent recruiters are increasingly in demand.

Room C3 Administration

Administrators keep organisations running efficiently day to day — the operational backbone behind every functioning office.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's or Diploma in Business Administration or Office Management.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coordinating schedules, managing resources, and solving the dozens of small logistical problems that come up daily.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Organisation

Multitasking

Communication

Problem-solving

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Office Manager, Executive Assistant to senior leadership, or Operations Manager.

Good to know: Strong administrators are often the quiet reason a busy organisation doesn't fall apart.

Room C3 Change Management

Change managers guide organisations through major transitions — mergers, restructures, new systems — successfully and with less disruption.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business or Organisational Psychology, often with change management certification (e.g. Prosci).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Mapping how a change will affect people, then designing communication and training to bring them along.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Empathy

Strategic communication

Project management

Resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into management consulting or senior organisational transformation leadership.

Good to know: Most major company failures during change come from ignoring the people side — this career exists to prevent that.

Supply Chain, Logistics & Procurement

Room C4 Supply Chain Management

Supply chain managers design and run the end-to-end flow of goods — from raw material to finished product on a shelf.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, Maths helps. Bachelor's in Supply Chain Management or Logistics, e.g. JKUAT, Kenyatta University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coordinating suppliers, transport, and inventory to make sure nothing runs out — and nothing sits unsold too long.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Systems thinking

Negotiation

Data analysis

Problem-solving under pressure

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Supply Chain Director, or specialise in international trade logistics.

Good to know: Every stockout or shortage you've ever seen in a shop was, somewhere, a supply chain problem.

Room C4 Logistics

Logistics professionals plan and coordinate how goods move efficiently across distances — the practical engine behind supply chains.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's or Diploma in Logistics and Transport Management.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Scheduling shipments, tracking deliveries, and solving problems when a truck breaks down or a shipment is delayed.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Planning

Problem-solving

Negotiation

Attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Logistics Manager, or move into international freight forwarding.

Good to know: Kenya's position as a regional trade gateway (via the Port of Mombasa) makes logistics a genuinely strategic national industry.

Room C4

Procurement

Procurement professionals source and negotiate the goods and services an organisation needs — getting the best value without compromising quality.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Procurement and Supply Chain Management, e.g. JKUAT, Technical University of Kenya, plus CIPS certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Evaluating suppliers, negotiating contracts, and ensuring purchases meet both budget and quality standards.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Negotiation

Analytical thinking

Ethics (anti-corruption)

Contract literacy

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Procurement, or specialise in public sector/government procurement.

Good to know: *Strong, transparent procurement is one of the most direct ways an organisation — or government — can prevent corruption.*

Room C4

Warehousing

Warehousing professionals manage the storage and distribution hubs that keep supply chains moving smoothly.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma or Bachelor's in Logistics, Supply Chain, or Business.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Overseeing inventory accuracy, warehouse layout, and the flow of goods in and out.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Organisation

Inventory systems

Team management

Efficiency mindset

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Warehouse/Distribution Centre Manager, or specialise in cold-chain (refrigerated) logistics.

Good to know: *Kenya's growing e-commerce sector has made modern, efficient warehousing a fast-growing specialty.*

Distribution professionals get finished products to the right place, on time — the last stretch between a warehouse and a customer.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma or Bachelor's in Logistics, Transport, or Business.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Planning delivery routes, managing transport fleets, and troubleshooting delays before they become customer complaints.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Route planning

Fleet coordination

Problem-solving

Customer awareness

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Distribution Manager, or move into national/regional supply chain leadership.

Good to know: Kenya's *boda boda* and delivery-app economy has completely reshaped last-mile distribution in the last decade.

Marketing, PR, Sales, Comms & CX

Room C5 Advertising

Advertisers create the campaigns that make brands unforgettable — the concepts, visuals, and messages that stop you mid-scroll.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Art. Bachelor's in Marketing, Communications, or Creative Advertising, e.g. USIU, Daystar University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Brainstorming campaign concepts, working with designers, and pitching ideas to clients.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Creativity

Persuasive writing

Visual sense

Client management

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Creative Director, or start your own advertising agency.

Good to know: Kenyan ad agencies regularly win awards at pan-African and global advertising festivals.

Room C5 Branding

Branding specialists shape how an organisation looks, sounds, and feels to the world — the identity behind every logo, tone, and customer impression.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Art. Bachelor's in Marketing, Design, or Communications.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Developing brand guidelines, working with design teams, and ensuring every customer touchpoint feels consistent.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Strategic thinking

Design sensibility

Storytelling

Consistency/attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Brand, or become an independent brand consultant.

Good to know: A strong brand can let a company charge more for the exact same product — branding has real, measurable value.

Room C5 Communications

Communications professionals manage how organisations speak to the public and the press — protecting and building reputation.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in Communications, Journalism, or Public Relations, e.g. University of Nairobi, Daystar University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Writing press releases, managing media relationships, and preparing leaders for public appearances or crises.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Writing

Crisis management

Media relationships

Strategic judgement

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Communications/PR, or move into political or corporate spokesperson roles.

Good to know: *In a crisis, the right communications response can save — or the wrong one can sink — an organisation's reputation.*

Room C5 Customer Experience (CX)

CX professionals design every touchpoint a customer has with a brand — making sure the experience matches the promise.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Marketing, Business, or Psychology.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Mapping customer journeys, analysing feedback, and redesigning processes that frustrate customers.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Empathy

Data analysis

Process design

Cross-team collaboration

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Customer Experience, or specialise in CX for a specific industry like banking or telecoms.

Good to know: *Kenyan banks and telcos have invested heavily in CX as mobile services made customer expectations much higher.*

Room C5 Market Development

Market development professionals identify and grow new markets for products and services — finding where the next big opportunity is.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Marketing, Business, or Economics.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Researching new customer segments or regions, and building the strategy to enter them successfully.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Market research

Strategic analysis

Cross-cultural awareness

Presentation skills

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Market Development, or move into regional/international expansion roles.

Good to know: Many Kenyan companies now expanding across East Africa rely on market development specialists to plan that growth.

Room C5 Corporate Social Responsibility

CSR professionals lead how businesses give back and act responsibly — running community, environmental, and ethical programmes.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Business, Development Studies, or Communications.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing community programmes, measuring their impact, and reporting on the company's social commitments.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Programme management

Stakeholder engagement

Impact measurement

Communication

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Sustainability/CSR, or move into the NGO sector.

Good to know: Most large Kenyan companies now run dedicated CSR foundations addressing education, health, or environment.

Sales Process Engineering

Sales process engineers design the systems that turn interest into revenue — the structure behind how a sales team actually closes deals.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, Maths helps. Bachelor's in Business, Sales, or Data Analytics.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Analysing sales data, redesigning processes, and training teams on more effective, repeatable sales techniques.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Process design

Data analysis

Sales knowledge

Training/coaching

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Sales Operations, or move into revenue operations leadership.

Good to know: *Companies with well-engineered sales processes consistently outperform those relying on individual salespeople's instincts alone.*

D

Law, Governance, Public Service & Faith

*"You care about justice, service, leadership, and doing right by
your community."*

Legal Practitioners

Room D1 Legal Scholarship

Legal scholars research and shape how the law itself develops — through academic writing, case analysis, and influence on future legislation.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor of Laws (LLB), 4 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, Strathmore University, Kabarak University, followed by postgraduate research.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Deep reading, writing legal analysis, and sometimes advising courts or lawmakers on complex legal questions.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Rigorous analysis

Academic writing

Argumentation

Patience for detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Become a law professor, join a think tank, or advise on constitutional and policy reform.

Good to know: Kenya's 2010 Constitution — one of the most progressive in Africa — was shaped by decades of legal scholarship.

Room D1 Advocacy (Attorneys)

Advocates represent clients and argue cases in court — the lawyers most people picture when they think 'lawyer.'

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. LLB (4 years) then the Kenya School of Law's Advocates Training Programme (ATP) and Bar exam.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Client meetings, case preparation, and courtroom appearances that can turn on a single well-made argument.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Argumentation

Research

Composure under pressure

Client management

WHERE IT LEADS

Make partner at a law firm, specialise (corporate, criminal, human rights), or run your own practice.

Good to know: Kenyan advocates have argued landmark cases that shaped constitutional rights across East Africa.

Room D1

Judiciary

Judges interpret the law and deliver rulings — one of the most respected and consequential roles in any justice system.

GETTING THERE

LLB, ATP, years of practice as an advocate, then appointment via the Judicial Service Commission (typically a later-career path).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Hearing cases, reviewing evidence and arguments, and writing judgments that must stand up to scrutiny and appeal.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Impartial judgement

Deep legal knowledge

Clear writing

Integrity

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress from magistrate to High Court, Court of Appeal, or Supreme Court judge.

Good to know: *Becoming a judge in Kenya typically requires years of distinguished legal practice first — it's a destination, not an entry point.*

Room D1

Paralegal Work

Paralegals support legal teams with research and case preparation, doing much of the groundwork that makes a lawyer's case possible.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma in Law or Paralegal Studies, e.g. Kenya School of Law, various colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Legal research, document drafting, and organising case files ahead of court dates or client meetings.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Research

Attention to detail

Organisation

Legal writing basics

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior paralegal roles, or use the experience as a stepping stone into an LLB.

Good to know: *Many successful advocates started their legal careers working as paralegals.*

Room D1 Notary Services

Notaries certify and authenticate legal documents — the official witness that makes documents legally trustworthy.

GETTING THERE

LLB plus advocate qualification, with additional notary public appointment (typically an experienced-advocate specialisation).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Verifying identities and signatures, certifying documents, and ensuring transactions are legally sound.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Precision

Legal knowledge

Integrity

Attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Often combined with a broader advocacy or conveyancing practice.

Good to know: *Notarised documents are required for major transactions like property sales and international paperwork.*

Room D1 Mediation

Mediators resolve disputes outside the courtroom, fairly and efficiently, helping both sides reach an agreement without a trial.

GETTING THERE

LLB or relevant degree, plus specialised mediation/ADR (Alternative Dispute Resolution) certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Facilitating structured conversations between disputing parties, staying neutral while guiding them toward resolution.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Neutrality

Active listening

Conflict resolution

Patience

WHERE IT LEADS

Build an independent mediation practice, or work within court-annexed mediation programmes.

Good to know: *Kenyan courts increasingly refer cases to mediation first, easing pressure on an overloaded court system.*

Room D1

Prosecution

Prosecutors represent the state in criminal cases, deciding what to charge and arguing the case against the accused in court.

GETTING THERE

LLB, ATP, then recruitment into the Office of the Director of Public Prosecutions (ODPP).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Reviewing police evidence, building a case, and arguing it in court against defence advocates.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Case-building

Public speaking

Ethical judgement

Resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior state counsel, or specialise in areas like anti-corruption or organised crime prosecution.

Good to know: Kenya's ODPP is constitutionally independent — designed specifically to prosecute without political interference.

Room D1

Judicial Administration

Judicial administrators keep the machinery of courts and justice running — scheduling, records, and operations behind every case.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Public Administration, Law, or Business Administration.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Managing court schedules, records, and the day-to-day logistics that let judges and lawyers do their jobs.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Organisation

Systems management

Attention to detail

Discretion

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Judiciary registrar or senior court administration roles.

Good to know: A well-run court registry is often the difference between a case resolved in months versus years.

Int'l Relations, Development & Governance

Room D2 Policy Development

Policy developers design the rules and frameworks that shape public life — from education policy to national economic strategy.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Humanities. Bachelor's in Public Policy, Economics, or Political Science, e.g. University of Nairobi, USIU.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Researching issues, drafting policy proposals, and consulting stakeholders before recommendations go to decision-makers.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Research

Analytical writing

Stakeholder engagement

Systems thinking

WHERE IT LEADS

Work within government ministries, think tanks, or international development agencies.

Good to know: Kenya's policy landscape — from devolution to digital ID systems — has been shaped by a small, influential community of policy specialists.

Room D2 Public Participation

Public participation specialists ensure citizens have a real voice in governance decisions, running consultations that shape policy from the ground up.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Political Science, Development Studies, or Public Administration.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Organising community forums, gathering input, and translating public opinion into formal policy input.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Facilitation

Communication across communities

Organisation

Neutrality

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into county government leadership, or specialise in governance-focused NGO work.

Good to know: Kenya's Constitution requires public participation in most major government decisions — a genuinely legally protected career area.

Room D2

Civic Education

Civic educators teach communities how to engage with democracy and their rights — voting, accountability, and civic participation.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Humanities. Bachelor's in Political Science, Education, or Development Studies.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Running workshops and training sessions that help ordinary citizens understand and use their civic rights.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Teaching/facilitation

Communication

Patience

Political literacy

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into election management (IEBC), NGO governance programmes, or public sector training.

Good to know: Civic educators play a real role every election cycle, helping first-time voters understand the process.

Room D2

NGO & Foundation Work

NGO professionals lead programmes that address social and humanitarian needs — from education to emergency relief.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Development Studies, Social Sciences, or a relevant technical field.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Managing programmes, writing funding proposals, and measuring impact on the communities being served.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Programme management

Grant writing

Cross-cultural communication

Resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Country Director, or move into international humanitarian leadership.

Good to know: Nairobi hosts the regional or Africa headquarters of many major global NGOs and UN agencies.

Room D2

Diplomacy

Diplomats represent your country's interests on the world stage — negotiating agreements and maintaining international relationships.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in International Relations or Political Science, then entry via the Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Meetings with foreign counterparts, drafting diplomatic communication, and representing national interests carefully.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Negotiation

Cultural fluency

Discretion

Written and spoken precision

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress through embassy postings to ambassador-level roles.

Good to know: Kenyan diplomats play an active role in regional bodies like the East African Community and the African Union.

Room D2

Think Tank Research

Think tank researchers shape policy debates through rigorous, independent research — the evidence behind public arguments.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Humanities. Bachelor's (often Master's) in Economics, Political Science, or a relevant specialisation.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Deep research, writing policy briefs, and sometimes presenting findings directly to policymakers or the media.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Research rigor

Analytical writing

Data literacy

Public communication

WHERE IT LEADS

Become a senior policy fellow, or move between research and government advisory roles.

Good to know: Kenyan think tanks have directly influenced major national debates on issues like debt, devolution, and digital rights.

Conference Interpretation

Conference interpreters enable real-time communication across languages at the highest levels — diplomacy, international courts, global summits.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English plus a second/third language.
Bachelor's in Translation and Interpretation or Linguistics,
plus specialised interpreter training.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Real-time interpretation during high-stakes meetings,
requiring total concentration and split-second precision.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Multilingual fluency

Intense concentration

Quick thinking

Cultural knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the UN, African Union, or international courts and conferences.

Good to know: *Nairobi's status as a UN hub city creates real, ongoing demand for skilled conference interpreters.*

Uniformed & National Security Services

Room D3 Kenya Defence Forces (KDF)

KDF officers and personnel serve and lead in the nation's armed forces — defending national sovereignty and supporting peacekeeping missions abroad.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, fitness standards. Direct entry or via the National Defence College; officers often hold a relevant degree.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Varies hugely by role — from training and logistics to active deployment, engineering, or medical support within the forces.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Discipline

Physical fitness

Leadership under pressure

Teamwork

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress through officer ranks, or specialise in engineering, medicine, or logistics within the forces.

Good to know: *The KDF has served in African Union peacekeeping missions, including in Somalia, representing Kenya internationally.*

Room D3 National Police Service

Police officers protect communities and enforce the law — from community policing to specialised investigative units.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, fitness standards. Recruitment via the National Police Service Commission, with training at police colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Patrols, community engagement, investigations, or specialised unit work, depending on assignment.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Judgement under pressure

Physical fitness

Communication

Integrity

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress through ranks to senior command, or specialise into forensics, cybercrime, or traffic units.

Good to know: *Kenya's police service has been actively modernising, including new specialised cybercrime and forensic units.*

Room D3

Kenya Prisons Service

Prisons service officers manage correctional facilities and support rehabilitation, balancing security with genuine efforts at reform.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, fitness standards. Recruitment via the Kenya Prisons Service, with training at prison staff colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Managing facility security, overseeing rehabilitation programmes, and working directly with incarcerated individuals.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Discipline

Communication

Composure

Fairness

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress through ranks, or specialise in correctional psychology and rehabilitation programme design.

Good to know: Kenya's prisons service runs education and vocational training programmes aimed at genuine post-release reintegration.

Room D3

National Youth Service (NYS)

NYS leaders run national service and youth development programmes, combining discipline training with practical skills development.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Entry via NYS recruitment; leadership roles often require further training or a relevant degree.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Overseeing training programmes, youth development projects, or infrastructure/service projects run by NYS units.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Leadership

Programme management

Discipline

Community engagement

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress into senior NYS command, or transition into broader public youth development policy roles.

Good to know: NYS graduates have gone on to build national infrastructure projects while gaining practical trade skills.

Room D3

Immigration Services

Immigration officers manage the nation's borders and citizenship processes — who enters, who stays, and how documentation is verified.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in a relevant field (Law, Public Administration), then entry via the Department of Immigration Services.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Processing applications, verifying documentation, and managing border points or citizenship services.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Attention to detail

Regulatory knowledge

Composure

Integrity

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior immigration department leadership or specialised border security roles.

Good to know: Kenya's e-visa and digital ID systems have made immigration services an increasingly tech-driven career.

Room D3

Coast Guard

Coast Guard personnel protect Kenya's waters, ports, and maritime borders — from search and rescue to anti-smuggling operations.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, fitness standards. Recruitment via the Kenya Coast Guard Service, often with maritime-specific training.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Maritime patrols, search and rescue operations, and enforcement of fishing and shipping regulations.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Maritime skills

Physical fitness

Quick decision-making

Teamwork

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress through ranks to senior maritime security command roles.

Good to know: The Kenya Coast Guard Service was formally established to protect the country's significant Indian Ocean economic interests.

Theology & Pastoral Care

Room D4 Theology

Theologians study and teach the foundations of faith and belief — the scholarly discipline behind religious leadership and thought.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Humanities. Bachelor's in Theology or Divinity, e.g. St. Paul's University, Africa Nazarene University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Study, teaching, writing, and often direct engagement with a faith community's questions and needs.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Deep study/scholarship

Writing

Public speaking

Empathy

WHERE IT LEADS

Become a seminary lecturer, denominational leader, or published theological scholar.

Good to know: Kenya is home to major theological seminaries that train religious leaders across East Africa.

Room D4 Pastoral Studies

Pastoral studies graduates train formally for religious and spiritual leadership — preparing to guide congregations and communities.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma or Bachelor's in Pastoral Studies/Ministry, e.g. various theological colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coursework blending theology, counselling, and practical ministry skills, often alongside supervised congregational placement.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Empathy

Public speaking

Study discipline

Community-mindedness

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into full-time pastoral ministry, chaplaincy, or denominational leadership.

Good to know: Many Kenyan churches require formal pastoral training before ordination, making this a genuine academic pathway.

Room D4

Pastoral Care

Pastoral care providers offer spiritual and emotional support to individuals and communities through life's hardest moments.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma/Bachelor's in Pastoral Care or Counselling, often combined with theological study.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

One-on-one support conversations, hospital or crisis visits, and community counselling.

SKILLS THAT MATTER**Deep listening****Emotional resilience****Confidentiality****Compassion****WHERE IT LEADS**

Specialise into hospital/hospice chaplaincy, or lead a congregation's pastoral care programme.

Good to know: *Hospital chaplains — a pastoral care specialisation — are now a formal part of many major Kenyan hospitals' care teams.*

Room D4

Spiritual Ministry

Spiritual ministry leaders lead worship, congregations, and faith communities, shaping both belief and communal life.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Theological training (Diploma to Bachelor's) plus denominational ordination requirements.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Sermon preparation, worship leadership, and pastoral engagement with a congregation's needs.

SKILLS THAT MATTER**Public speaking****Leadership****Empathy****Organisational skill****WHERE IT LEADS**

Lead a growing congregation, plant a new church, or move into denominational leadership.

Good to know: *Faith communities remain among the most influential social institutions in Kenya, reaching far beyond Sunday services.*

Education

Room D5 Early Childhood Education

ECE teachers shape the earliest, most formative years of learning — building the foundation every later education stage builds on.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma or Bachelor's in Early Childhood Education, e.g. Kenyatta University, KMTC-affiliated colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Play-based learning activities, foundational literacy and numeracy, and close observation of each child's development.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Patience

Creativity

Child development knowledge

Warmth

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to school leadership, curriculum development, or ECE policy roles.

Good to know: Kenya's CBC (Competency-Based Curriculum) placed new emphasis on strong early-years foundations — raising ECE's national importance.

Room D5 Primary Education

Primary teachers guide the foundational school years, building core literacy, numeracy, and life skills.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma in Primary Education (P1, via KMTC/TTCs) or Bachelor of Education (Primary Option).

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Full teaching days across multiple subjects, plus marking, lesson planning, and pastoral care of the class.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Patience

Communication

Classroom management

Adaptability

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to headteacher, curriculum specialist, or teacher training college lecturer.

Good to know: Primary teachers under Kenya's CBC now play a bigger role in continuous, project-based assessment, not just exams.

Room D5

Secondary Education

Secondary teachers teach and mentor teenagers through their most pivotal academic years, specialising in one or two subjects.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong grades in your teaching subjects. Bachelor of Education (Secondary Option), e.g. Kenyatta University, Moi University, Egerton University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Subject-specific lessons across multiple classes, exam preparation, and mentoring students navigating big decisions.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Subject mastery

Classroom management

Mentorship

Patience

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Department, Deputy Principal, or Principal.

Good to know: *You are, right now, being taught by people who chose exactly this career path.*

Room D5

Home Education

Home education specialists design and deliver individualised, at-home learning — a growing alternative pathway for some families.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor of Education, often with specific curriculum design experience.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

One-on-one or small-group teaching tailored precisely to an individual learner's pace and needs.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Curriculum design

Adaptability

Patience

Strong subject knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Build an independent home-schooling consultancy, or specialise in curriculum design for homeschool families.

Good to know: *Home education is a small but growing niche in Kenya, often chosen for learners with special circumstances.*

Room D5

Special Needs Education

Special needs educators teach and advocate for learners with diverse needs, adapting teaching methods to make education genuinely inclusive.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor of Education (Special Needs), e.g. Kenyatta University, University of Nairobi.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Individualised lesson delivery, close collaboration with therapists and families, and constant adaptation to each learner.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Deep patience

Creativity

Specialised technique knowledge

Advocacy

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to special needs school leadership, or shape national inclusive education policy.

Good to know: Kenya has significantly expanded inclusive education policy in recent years, growing demand for trained specialists.

Room D5

TVET (Technical & Vocational)

TVET trainers teach practical, hands-on trade and technical skills — the instructors behind Kenya's skilled workforce in construction, mechanics, catering, and more.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade, plus deep expertise in the specific trade. Diploma/Bachelor's in Technical Education, or trade mastery plus a teaching certificate.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Hands-on workshop or practical sessions, teaching a trade skill students can use immediately after graduating.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Trade mastery

Practical teaching ability

Patience

Safety consciousness

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to TVET institution leadership, or specialise in curriculum development for a specific trade.

Good to know: Kenya has made major national investment in TVET institutions, recognising skilled trades as critical to the economy.

Tertiary & Academia

University lecturers and academics teach, research, and lead at the highest level of education, expanding knowledge in their field.

GETTING THERE

Bachelor's, then Master's, then typically a PhD in your specialisation — a long but rewarding academic pathway.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Lecturing, research, supervising student projects, and publishing findings that add to global knowledge.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Deep subject expertise

Research rigor

Teaching ability

Persistence (long study path)

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to full professorship, university leadership, or influential public research roles.

Good to know: Kenyan academics contribute research across every field in this guide — academia is the career that studies all the others.

E

Creative Industries, Media, Hospitality & Built Environment

*"You express yourself through stories, design, image, food, or
building the world around you."*

Journalism & The Media

Room E1 Broadcast Media

Broadcast media professionals report and produce news and content for TV and radio, shaping how millions get their daily information.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in Journalism or Mass Communication, e.g. University of Nairobi, Daystar University, USIU.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Chasing stories, filming or recording segments, and working against tight broadcast deadlines.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

On-camera/on-air presence

Writing under deadline

Interviewing

Composure live

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior anchor, producer, or newsroom editorial leadership.

Good to know: Kenyan broadcast journalists have covered major regional and global stories, building genuinely international careers.

Room E1 Print Media

Print journalists write and edit for newspapers, magazines, and publications — the in-depth, considered side of news.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in Journalism or Mass Communication.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Researching, interviewing, and writing stories with more depth and time than broadcast news usually allows.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Strong writing

Research

Fact-checking rigor

Editing

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior editor, or move into long-form investigative journalism.

Good to know: Kenyan investigative print journalism has exposed major corruption scandals that reshaped public policy.

Room E1

Digital & Social Media

Digital media professionals build and manage online platforms and audiences — the modern newsroom that lives on phones, not paper.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English. Bachelor's in Journalism, Communications, or Digital Media.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Creating content, tracking engagement data, and adapting stories for platforms that all work differently.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Multi-platform storytelling

Data awareness

Fast adaptation

Visual sense

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head of Digital, or build an independent digital media brand.

Good to know: Kenya has one of Africa's most active social media cultures — 'Kenyans on Twitter' regularly drives national conversations.

Room E1

Blogging

Bloggers build an independent voice and audience around their expertise — writing consistently on a topic they know deeply.

GETTING THERE

No fixed academic path — strong writing and subject expertise matter most; a Communications degree helps but isn't required.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Researching and writing posts, engaging with an audience, and often managing the business side of a personal platform.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Consistent writing

Niche expertise

Basic SEO/digital skills

Self-discipline

WHERE IT LEADS

Grow into a media brand, book deal, or brand partnership income stream.

Good to know: Several Kenyan bloggers have built platforms large enough to become full-time, self-sustaining careers.

Room E1

Vlogging

Vloggers tell stories and build community through video content — from lifestyle to education to comedy.

GETTING THERE

No fixed academic path — video/editing skill and consistency matter most; a Film/Media degree can help refine craft.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Filming, editing, and publishing video content, then engaging directly with an audience in comments and community.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Video production/editing

On-camera comfort

Storytelling

Consistency

WHERE IT LEADS

Grow a channel into a full media business with sponsorships and brand deals.

Good to know: Kenyan YouTubers and content creators increasingly earn full-time incomes through ad revenue and brand partnerships.

Room E1

Podcasting

Podcasters create long-form audio content and conversation — a fast-growing format for storytelling, interviews, and commentary.

GETTING THERE

No fixed academic path — strong interviewing/storytelling ability matters most; a Communications degree can help.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Planning episodes, recording conversations, and editing audio into a polished final product.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Interviewing

Audio editing basics

Storytelling

Consistency

WHERE IT LEADS

Grow into sponsorship deals, live events, or a full independent media company.

Good to know: Kenya's podcast scene has grown rapidly, covering everything from business to comedy to true crime.

Hospitality & Tourism

Room E2 Gastronomy (Culinary Arts)

Professional chefs and culinary experts train in the art and science of food — running kitchens, developing menus, and creating memorable dining experiences.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Certificate/Diploma in Culinary Arts (TVET track), e.g. Utalii College, 1-3 years, with apprenticeship experience.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Fast-paced kitchen service, precise food preparation, and constant coordination with a full kitchen team under pressure.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical cooking skill

Speed under pressure

Creativity

Team leadership

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head Chef, open your own restaurant, or specialise in pastry or a specific cuisine.

Good to know: Kenya Utalii College is one of Africa's most respected hospitality training institutions, producing chefs who work worldwide.

Room E2 Event Management

Event managers plan and execute events — from weddings to global conferences — coordinating every moving piece to come together on the day.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma/Bachelor's in Event Management or Hospitality, e.g. Kenya Utalii College, KCA University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Vendor coordination, timeline management, and problem-solving in real time when something inevitably changes last minute.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Organisation

Composure under pressure

Negotiation

Multitasking

WHERE IT LEADS

Build an independent event planning company, or specialise in large-scale corporate/international events.

Good to know: Nairobi hosts major international conferences regularly, creating strong demand for skilled event professionals.

Room E2

Destination Marketing

Destination marketers sell the story of a place to the world — the campaigns that make travellers choose Kenya over anywhere else.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Tourism Management or Marketing, e.g. Kenyatta University, Kenya Utalii College.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Creating campaigns, building partnerships with travel media, and showcasing what makes a destination worth visiting.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Storytelling

Marketing strategy

Photography/visual sense

Industry relationships

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with the Kenya Tourism Board, county tourism offices, or international travel brands.

Good to know: *Tourism is one of Kenya's top foreign exchange earners — destination marketers directly drive that economic impact.*

Room E2

Conference Management

Conference managers run large-scale business and international events, handling everything from delegate logistics to venue technology.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma/Bachelor's in Event or Hospitality Management.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coordinating venues, speakers, delegates, and technology for events that can host thousands of attendees.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Large-scale logistics

Vendor management

Problem-solving

Composure under pressure

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior roles at major convention centres, or specialise in international summit management.

Good to know: *Nairobi's Kenyatta International Convention Centre hosts major African Union and UN-level conferences.*

Room E2

Tours & Travel

Tours and travel professionals design and guide unforgettable travel experiences — from safari itineraries to international trip planning.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Diploma/Bachelor's in Tourism Management, e.g. Kenya Utalii College, Moi University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Planning itineraries, guiding groups, and solving the inevitable logistics hiccups of travel in real time.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Destination knowledge

Customer service

Problem-solving

Multilingual ability (a plus)

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior tour operator management, or start your own travel company.

Good to know: Kenya's safari tourism industry is globally renowned — tour guides here are considered among the best trained in the world.

Room E2

Sommelier

Sommeliers are certified wine experts — advising on selection, pairing, and service in top restaurants and hotels.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Specialised sommelier certification programmes (international bodies like WSET), often after hospitality training.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Curating wine lists, training service staff, and guiding guests through pairing choices.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Palate expertise

Memory for detail

Customer service

Continuous tasting/study

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Head Sommelier at a top hotel, or specialise in wine import/distribution.

Good to know: Kenya's high-end hospitality sector, serving international tourists, has growing demand for certified sommeliers.

Oenologists study and practice the science of winemaking — from grape selection to fermentation to final bottling.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Chemistry, Biology. Specialised oenology/ winemaking study, typically abroad given Kenya's limited wine industry.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Lab analysis, monitoring fermentation, and making technical decisions that shape a wine's final character.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Chemistry knowledge

Sensory analysis

Patience

Attention to process detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with emerging African vineyards, or in wine import/quality control roles.

Good to know: *While niche in Kenya today, oenology is a growing interest as boutique African vineyards begin to emerge.*

The Arts — Applied, Visual, Performing & Literary

Room E3 Fashion & Couture Design

Fashion designers create original clothing and collections — from concept sketch to finished, wearable garment.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Art/Design helps. Diploma/Bachelor's in Fashion Design (TVET track available), e.g. Buruburu Institute of Fine Art, Evelyn College of Design.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Sketching designs, sourcing fabric, and working through pattern-making and construction to bring a concept to life.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Sketching/design sense

Sewing/construction skill

Trend awareness

Business sense

WHERE IT LEADS

Launch your own fashion label, work for an established house, or move into costume design.

Good to know: Kenyan fashion designers have shown collections at international fashion weeks, building genuinely global brands.

Room E3 Graphic Design

Graphic designers visually communicate ideas across every kind of media — logos, packaging, websites, and campaigns.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Art/Design helps. Diploma/Bachelor's in Graphic Design, e.g. Buruburu Institute of Fine Art, various design colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Working in design software to create visuals that meet a brief, then revising based on client feedback.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Visual composition

Design software (Adobe Suite)

Client communication

Creativity under constraints

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Creative Director, or freelance/build a design studio.

Good to know: Graphic design is one of the most flexible creative careers — genuinely practicable as a freelancer from anywhere.

Room E3 Interior Design

Interior designers shape how spaces look, feel, and function — from private homes to hotels and offices.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Art/Design helps. Diploma/Bachelor's in Interior Design, e.g. Buruburu Institute of Fine Art, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Client consultations, space planning, and coordinating with contractors to bring a design vision to life.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Spatial visualisation

Design software

Client management

Practical material knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Start an independent design practice, or specialise in hospitality/commercial interiors.

Good to know: Kenya's growing hospitality and real estate sectors have created strong demand for skilled interior designers.

Room E3 Photography

Photographers capture and tell stories through still images — from weddings to journalism to fine art.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream, Art helps. Diploma in Photography (TVET track available) or self-taught with strong portfolio.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Shooting sessions or assignments, followed by editing to deliver a final, polished set of images.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical camera skill

Composition/eye for detail

Editing software

Client management

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise in weddings, fashion, photojournalism, or build a fine art photography career.

Good to know: Kenyan photojournalists have had their work featured in major international publications, documenting stories worldwide.

Room E3 Videography

Videographers tell stories through moving images and film — from commercials to documentaries to music videos.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Diploma in Film/Videography, e.g. Kenya Institute of Mass Communication, or self-taught with strong portfolio.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Filming shoots, then hours of editing to shape raw footage into a finished, compelling story.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Camera operation

Video editing software

Storytelling

Technical lighting/sound knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Move into film directing, advertising production, or documentary filmmaking.

Good to know: Kenya's film industry has grown internationally, with local productions gaining recognition at festivals worldwide.

Room E3 Painting & Sculpture

Painters and sculptors create original fine art in two and three dimensions, exhibiting and selling work as professional artists.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Art helps. Diploma/Bachelor's in Fine Art, e.g. Buruburu Institute of Fine Art, various art schools, or independent practice.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Studio time creating work, alongside the business side — exhibitions, galleries, and building a collector base.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical artistic skill

Original creative vision

Business/self-promotion

Persistence

WHERE IT LEADS

Build a gallery-represented career, or move into public/commissioned art.

Good to know: *Kenyan contemporary artists exhibit and sell work in galleries across Africa, Europe, and the US.*

Room E3 Sound Engineering

Sound engineers record, mix, and produce professional audio — for music, film, radio, and live events.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Certificate/Diploma in Sound/Audio Engineering (TVET track), e.g. various media training institutes.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Recording sessions, mixing tracks, and solving technical audio problems live or in post-production.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical audio equipment knowledge

Musical ear

Patience

Software proficiency

WHERE IT LEADS

Work in music production, film sound, or live event audio engineering.

Good to know: *Kenya's music industry — from gospel to Gengetone — depends on skilled local sound engineers to compete globally.*

Room E3

DJ Techniques

DJs curate and mix music for live audiences, reading a room and shaping the energy of an event in real time.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Short courses/mentorship in DJ techniques (TVET-adjacent), plus building a demo/performance reputation.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Preparing playlists, then live performance requiring constant reading of crowd energy and technical mixing skill.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Musical knowledge

Technical mixing skill

Reading a crowd

Performance confidence

WHERE IT LEADS

Build a club/event residency, tour internationally, or move into music production.

Good to know: Kenyan DJs have built international followings, blending local genres like Gengetone into global sets.

Room E3

Dance

Dancers perform, choreograph, and teach movement as art — across styles from traditional to contemporary to commercial.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Training through dance schools, companies, or conservatories; formal Bachelor's in Dance available at some institutions.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Rehearsals, technique training, and performances or teaching sessions, all demanding serious physical conditioning.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Physical discipline

Musicality

Choreographic creativity

Performance presence

WHERE IT LEADS

Join a professional dance company, choreograph for major productions, or teach and open a dance studio.

Good to know: Kenyan traditional and contemporary dance is performed on international stages, blending heritage with modern choreography.

Room E3 Drama

Actors, directors, and drama producers bring stories to life for stage and screen, from theatre to film to TV.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream, English/Literature helps. Bachelor's in Theatre Arts/Film, e.g. Kenya National Theatre-linked training, Kenyatta University.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Rehearsals, script work, and performances — plus, for many, auditioning constantly between roles.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Performance craft

Memorisation

Emotional range

Resilience (rejection is common)

WHERE IT LEADS

Build a stage/screen acting career, move into directing, or write and produce original work.

Good to know: Kenyan actors and productions have gained growing recognition on streaming platforms and international festivals.

Room E3 Music

Musicians perform, compose, and produce music professionally — across genres from gospel to Afrobeat to classical.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream, Music helps. Formal training (Bachelor's in Music) or self-taught with strong performance/production skill.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Practising, writing or producing new material, and performing live or recording in studio.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Musical technique

Creativity

Business/self-promotion

Resilience

WHERE IT LEADS

Build a recording and touring career, or move into music production and songwriting for others.

Good to know: Kenyan artists have built genuinely global streaming audiences, especially in the Gengetone and Afro-fusion scenes.

Room E3 Creative Writing

Creative writers write fiction, essays, and creative nonfiction — building stories and ideas that move readers.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Literature. Bachelor's in Literature or Creative Writing, e.g. University of Nairobi, or independent practice with publication.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Writing, editing, and revising — often alongside submitting work to publishers, magazines, or competitions.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Strong prose

Discipline (daily writing)

Editing/self-critique

Persistence with rejection

WHERE IT LEADS

Publish novels or essay collections, write for major publications, or teach creative writing.

Good to know: Kenyan authors have won major international literary prizes, including the Caine Prize for African Writing.

Room E3 Poetry

Poets craft and perform the written and spoken word — from page poetry to spoken word and slam performance.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Literature. Bachelor's in Literature, or independent practice and performance experience.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Writing and revising work, and — for spoken word poets — rehearsing and performing at events and festivals.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Language craft

Performance (for spoken word)

Originality

Emotional honesty

WHERE IT LEADS

Publish poetry collections, build a spoken word performance career, or teach and mentor emerging poets.

Good to know: Nairobi's spoken word scene, including events like Poetry Slam Africa, has launched genuinely national poetry careers.

Room E3 Script-Writing

Scriptwriters write for film, TV, theatre, and stage — the structural and dialogue backbone of every production.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong English/Literature. Bachelor's in Film, Theatre, or Creative Writing, e.g. Kenyatta University, or self-taught with produced work.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Writing and revising scripts, often through multiple drafts and close collaboration with directors and producers.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Storytelling structure

Dialogue writing

Collaboration

Revision discipline

WHERE IT LEADS

Write for major TV productions, films, or build an independent screenwriting career.

Good to know: Kenya's growing local TV and streaming production industry has created real, paid demand for trained scriptwriters.

Room E3 Cosmetology

Cosmetologists train professionally in skincare and beauty treatments — facials, makeup artistry, and skin health.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Certificate/Diploma in Cosmetology (TVET track), e.g. various beauty training colleges, 6 months-2 years.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Client treatments and consultations, requiring both technical skill and a warm, professional client manner.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical treatment skill

Product knowledge

Client care

Hygiene standards

WHERE IT LEADS

Open your own beauty salon/spa, or become a specialist makeup artist for media and events.

Good to know: Kenya's beauty and personal care industry is a fast-growing, genuinely accessible entrepreneurship pathway.

Room E3 Hairdressing (Coiffeuring)

Hairdressers master the art and business of professional hairstyling — cutting, styling, and treating hair for clients.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Certificate/Diploma in Hairdressing (TVET track), e.g. various vocational training colleges, 6 months-2 years.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Back-to-back client appointments, each needing technical skill and an eye for what suits the individual.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical cutting/styling skill

Creativity

Client communication

Business sense

WHERE IT LEADS

Open your own salon, train other stylists, or specialise in bridal/editorial styling.

Good to know: Hairdressing remains one of Kenya's most widely practiced and reliably in-demand trade skills, in every town and county.

Room E3 Aesthetics

Aestheticians specialise in professional skincare and beauty therapy — treatments focused specifically on skin health and appearance.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: any stream. Certificate/Diploma in Aesthetics/Beauty Therapy (TVET track), e.g. various beauty training colleges.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Skin consultations and treatments, staying current on new techniques and products in a fast-evolving field.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical treatment skill

Skin science knowledge

Client care

Attention to hygiene

WHERE IT LEADS

Open a specialised skincare clinic, or move into medical aesthetics alongside dermatologists.

Good to know: Medical aesthetics — combining beauty therapy with clinical skin science — is one of the fastest-growing niches in the field.

The Built Environment & Real Estate

Room E4 Quantity Surveying

Quantity surveyors manage the costs and contracts of major construction projects, keeping budgets realistic from design to completion.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Quantity Surveying/Construction Management, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Costing materials and labour, reviewing contracts, and tracking spend against budget throughout a project.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Numerical precision

Contract knowledge

Negotiation

Attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior project cost consultant, or start an independent quantity surveying practice.

Good to know: No major Kenyan construction project — from apartments to highways — proceeds without a quantity surveyor's cost plan.

Room E4 Urban Planning

Urban planners design how entire cities and towns grow and function — zoning, transport, housing, and public space.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Geography, Maths. Bachelor's in Urban and Regional Planning, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Reviewing development plans, mapping growth patterns, and balancing competing needs for land and infrastructure.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Spatial analysis (GIS)

Policy knowledge

Stakeholder negotiation

Long-term thinking

WHERE IT LEADS

Work with county governments, or lead major national urban development projects.

Good to know: As Nairobi and other Kenyan cities grow rapidly, urban planners are shaping decisions that will last generations.

Room E4

Architecture

Architects design buildings that are beautiful, functional, and safe — from concept sketch through construction oversight.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths, Art helps. Bachelor of Architecture, 5 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT, followed by professional registration.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Design work, client meetings, and site visits to ensure a building is being constructed as designed.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Design creativity

Technical drawing/CAD

Client communication

Attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Start your own architecture firm, or specialise in sustainable/green building design.

Good to know: Kenyan architects are increasingly recognised internationally for innovative, climate-responsive design.

Room E4

Architectural Drafting

Architectural drafters turn design concepts into precise technical drawings that builders can actually construct from.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: Maths, Physics. Diploma in Architectural/Building Drafting, e.g. technical training institutes.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Producing detailed technical drawings and revisions, working closely with architects and engineers.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical drawing/CAD software

Precision

Spatial understanding

Attention to detail

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior drafter, or use it as a stepping stone toward a full architecture degree.

Good to know: Skilled drafters are essential to every architecture firm — precise drawings are what turns a design into a real building.

Room E4 Interior Architecture

Interior architects design the structural and spatial experience of interiors — more technical than interior design, closer to building structure.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths, Art helps. Bachelor's in Architecture or Interior Architecture.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing interior spatial layouts, working within structural constraints, and coordinating with architects and contractors.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Spatial/structural understanding

Design software

Technical knowledge

Collaboration

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise in commercial or hospitality interior architecture, or open an independent practice.

Good to know: Kenya's growing hotel and commercial real estate sector has increased demand for this specialised hybrid skill set.

Room E4 Site Engineering

Site engineers manage the technical execution of a construction site, translating design plans into real, safely built structures.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Bachelor's in Civil Engineering or Construction Management.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

On-site supervision, technical problem-solving, and ensuring construction matches engineering specifications exactly.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical engineering knowledge

On-site problem-solving

Safety management

Team supervision

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to Project Manager, or specialise in large infrastructure projects.

Good to know: Site engineers are the technical link between an architect's design and the workers actually building it.

Room E4 Civil Engineering

Civil engineers design and build roads, bridges, and public infrastructure — the physical systems entire economies run on.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths, Chemistry. Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering, 5 years, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing infrastructure, running structural calculations, and overseeing construction to make sure it's built safely.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Structural analysis

Project management

Problem-solving

Regulatory knowledge

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior infrastructure project leadership, or specialise in transport, water, or structural engineering.

Good to know: Major Kenyan infrastructure — the SGR railway, expressways, dams — was built by teams of civil engineers.

Room E4 Structural Engineering

Structural engineers ensure buildings and structures can safely stand and last — the calculations behind every skyscraper and bridge.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Bachelor's in Civil/Structural Engineering, often with further specialisation.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Running structural calculations and simulations, reviewing designs for safety, and signing off before construction proceeds.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Advanced physics/maths

Precision

Risk assessment

Regulatory compliance

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior structural consultant, or specialise in earthquake/disaster-resistant design.

Good to know: A structural engineer's sign-off is legally required before most major Kenyan buildings can be constructed.

Room E4

Building Services Engineering

Building services engineers design a building's power, water, and climate systems — the invisible infrastructure that makes a building livable.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Bachelor's in Electrical, Mechanical, or Building Services Engineering.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Designing electrical, plumbing, and HVAC systems, and coordinating with architects to integrate them seamlessly.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Multi-system engineering knowledge

Coordination

Technical precision

Problem-solving

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior building services consultant, or specialise in sustainable/green building systems.

Good to know: As Kenya adopts more green building standards, building services engineers are central to energy-efficient design.

Room E4

Energy Assessment (Buildings)

Building energy assessors evaluate and improve a building's energy efficiency — reducing costs and environmental impact.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Physics, Maths. Bachelor's in Engineering or Environmental Science, with energy auditing certification.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Auditing buildings' energy use and recommending upgrades that cut waste and costs.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Technical assessment

Energy systems knowledge

Report writing

Cost-benefit analysis

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to sustainability consulting, or specialise in green building certification (e.g. EDGE, LEED).

Good to know: This is a distinct specialisation from B3's power-sector Energy careers — this one is about buildings, not the grid.

Room E4

Construction Management

Construction managers oversee construction projects from design to completion — the people who keep a build on time and on budget.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: strong Maths, Physics. Bachelor's in Construction Management or Civil Engineering.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Coordinating contractors, tracking timelines and budgets, and solving the daily problems that come up on any building site.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Project management

Leadership

Problem-solving

Budget management

WHERE IT LEADS

Progress to senior project director, or start an independent construction management firm.

Good to know: *Construction managers are ultimately responsible for turning a stack of drawings into a finished, functioning building.*

Room E4

Real Estate

Real estate professionals broker, appraise, manage, and develop property — connecting buyers, sellers, and the built environment.

GETTING THERE

KCSE: solid overall grade. Bachelor's in Real Estate/Land Economics, e.g. University of Nairobi, JKUAT, plus professional registration.

A DAY IN THE LIFE

Property viewings, valuations, negotiations, or overseeing a development project, depending on your specific role.

SKILLS THAT MATTER

Negotiation

Market knowledge

Financial literacy

Relationship-building

WHERE IT LEADS

Specialise in property development, valuation, or build an independent real estate agency/brokerage.

Good to know: *Kenya's real estate sector, especially in Nairobi, has been one of the country's most active investment markets for two decades.*

QUICK REFERENCE

A-Z Career Search

All 162 professions, alphabetically — with the room and page for each full brief.

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